

Coastal Outfitters Risk Assessment Report

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Project Type: Simulated GRC Risk Assessment

Methodology: NIST-inspired risk assessment process

Purpose:

This assessment was conducted to identify and evaluate cybersecurity risks affecting organizational assets at Coastal Outfitters. The objective was to identify potential threats and vulnerabilities, determine their business impact, and recommend controls to reduce organizational risk exposure.

Scope:

The assessment included ten organizational assets used to support business operations and customer services.

Assets assessed:

- E-commerce web application
- Customer database
- Microsoft 365 environment
- Active Directory server
- Employee laptops
- Point-of-sale systems
- Splunk SIEM
- Cloud file storage
- VPN solution
- Backup server

Methodology:

The assessment followed a basic risk assessment methodology using asset identification, threat identification, and vulnerability analysis. Likelihood and impact values were assigned using a scale of 1–5 and risk scores were calculated by multiplying likelihood and impact values.

Risk formula:

$\text{Risk Score} = \text{Likelihood} \times \text{Impact}$

Risk levels:

- Low = 1–5
- Medium = 6–10
- High = 11–15

- Critical = 16–25

Critical Findings

Microsoft 365 – Phishing

- Threat: Phishing
- Vulnerability: Lack of employee security awareness training
- Risk Score: 20 (Critical)

Active Directory – Credential Theft

- Threat: Credential theft
- Vulnerability: Password policy has not been updated
- Risk Score: 20 (Critical)

Employee Laptops – Malware

- Threat: Malware
- Vulnerability: Users downloading unsafe files
- Risk Score: 20 (Critical)

Cloud Storage – Data Leakage

- Threat: Data leakage
- Vulnerability: Lack of employee understanding of procedures
- Risk Score: 20 (Critical)

Recommendations:

Priority 1:

- Implement MFA for Microsoft 365, VPN access, and Active Directory systems

Priority 2:

- Conduct employee security awareness training

Priority 3:

- Review password policies and strengthen authentication controls

Priority 4:

- Review user permissions and implement role-based access control (RBAC)

Priority 5:

- Improve backup protection strategies through offline or immutable backups

Overall Risk Assessment:

Coastal Outfitters' overall risk posture was assessed as **Moderate to High** due to multiple critical findings involving authentication weaknesses, employee awareness gaps, and risks affecting organizational data and systems.

Executive Summary:

Coastal Outfitters is an outdoor retail company with approximately 250 employees operating both online and through physical store locations. A risk assessment was conducted on ten organizational assets to identify threats, vulnerabilities, and potential business impacts. Several critical risks were identified, including phishing attempts targeting Microsoft 365 users, credential theft affecting Active Directory and VPN services, malware risks on employee systems, and potential data leakage from cloud storage systems. The organization's overall risk posture was assessed as Moderate to High and requires remediation efforts to reduce exposure. Recommended actions include improving employee security awareness training, strengthening password requirements, implementing multi-factor authentication (MFA), and improving procedures related to cloud storage and access management.

Conclusion:

The assessment identified several risks that may affect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of organizational systems and data. Implementation of the recommended controls will reduce risk exposure and improve the organization's overall security posture.